

THE DISIMPACTION REGIME FOR CHILDREN

INFORMATION SHEET FOR PARENTS



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The purpose of the Disimpaction Regime is to eliminate a backlog of poo with the use of a macrogol. This should be prescribed by your doctor and must be followed completely. The duration of the regimen varies, depending on the amount of poo present. You can expect to see a significant amount of poo, which may initially seem to worsen the situation, leading to increased episodes of soiling, urgency, and possibly some abdominal discomfort. This will be temporary, and improvement will follow.

If, after the first week, the disimpaction has not been completed then you need to discuss with your doctor about continuing on the highest dose and about the use of a stimulant laxative. You may be advised to continue with the highest dose for a week and then if needed to use a stimulant as well. Your child will need to stay at home to do this as there will be lots of poo passed and lots of macrogol to be drank. If appropriate to your child's needs you may plan in advance when you can do this if work etc needs to be factored into account. The most common mistake parents make when doing this is stopping too soon as they think that all this poo coming out can not be 'normal'. Also, being realistic it can be challenging to get your little one to drink the macrogol. Please see overleaf.

I hope this leaflet helps.

Paediatric Macrogol Sachet	DAY 1	DAY 2	DAY 3	DAY 4	DAY 5	DAY 6	DAY 7
Under 1 yr	$\frac{1}{2}$ - 1 <----->						
1-5 years	2	4	4	6	6	8	8
5-12 years	4	6	8	10	12	12	12

Adult Macrogol Sachet	DAY 1	DAY 2	DAY 3	DAY 4	DAY 5	DAY 6	DAY 7
Over 12 yrs	4	6	8	8	8	8	8

WHAT IS A MACROGOL?

Macrocols are an osmotic laxative. The brand names available here in Ireland are Movicol and Laxido that are used for disimpaction regime. it contains electrolytes which gives it a 'salty' taste.

HOW THESE WORK...

The active ingredient in these macrocols is the water that you mix with the powder in the sachet. The powder binds with the water to stop it from being absorbed in the body & brings it to the poo where it softens and breaks it up gradually.

HOW TO USE...

Mix each Paediatric sachet with 62.5mls of water & each Adult sachet with 125mls of water. Add water & stir well until clear then you can add some flavour to help with the taste. Do not over dilute. Do not add powder straight to food.

WHAT TO EXPECT WITH THE DISIMPACTION...

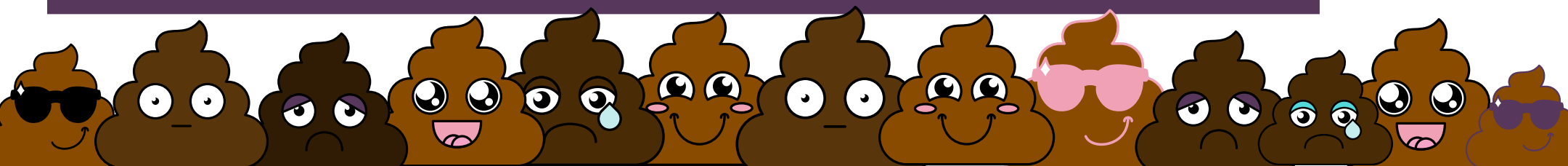
It will take 2-3 days generally to notice any difference in the poo. Then it will become softer, progress to mush & then liquid. Poo may change from liquid to mushy or formed again. The poo will vary in colour. Expect lots of poo. Some will experience soiling.

HOW LONG DOES IT TAKE?

This depends on how much poo is in there. Poo will vary from day to day. What you are aiming for is 24 hours of brown/rusty coloured water with speckles of poo in it. If on day 7 of the regime poo still is not this then you continue on the highest dose as per doctors instructions.

WHAT HAPPENS THEN AFTER DISIMPACTION?

Once disimpaction has been achieved then you reduce to half the daily dose it took. For example, if it took 8 sachets then you reduce to 4 sachets. Leave it at this dose for at least 5 days. Expect poo to stay sloppy. Then, further reduce to find the maintenance dose - see overleaf



Tip for drinking macrogols!

- If old enough, explain how it will help them - demonstrate by using a dry weetabix (this represents the old hard poo in the belly) pour some water over the weetabix (this represents the macrogol) & the weetabix will fluff up, expand and become softer - much like what happens with the poo when the macrogol mixture gets down to that poo
- If old enough, get them involved in making the sachets up with the water- they measure out the water with their own jug, use a little whisk to mix it, write the sticker to label it before putting it in the fridge. It can be made up the night before to save time in the morning. Chilling it can really help with the taste.
- Start with trying it plain first. If this is not agreeable then you can add other drinks too to disguise the taste - cordials, milk, fruit juices just don't over dilute the mixture. It can be added to a small amount of food - but be mindful what you add it to must be all ingested. I have a drinking game that you can print out that can be a fun way to drink it.
- The made up solution can be drunk throughout the 12 hours in the day - a certain amount does not have to be drunk by a certain time - some will drink little and often others will drink larger amounts less often.
- Devise a reward chart for completing the regime, a sticker is given for each glass drunk for example (give sticker straight away after each glass is drunk). Fill the chart & once the regime is completed/sheet is filled give the reward.

Practicalities...

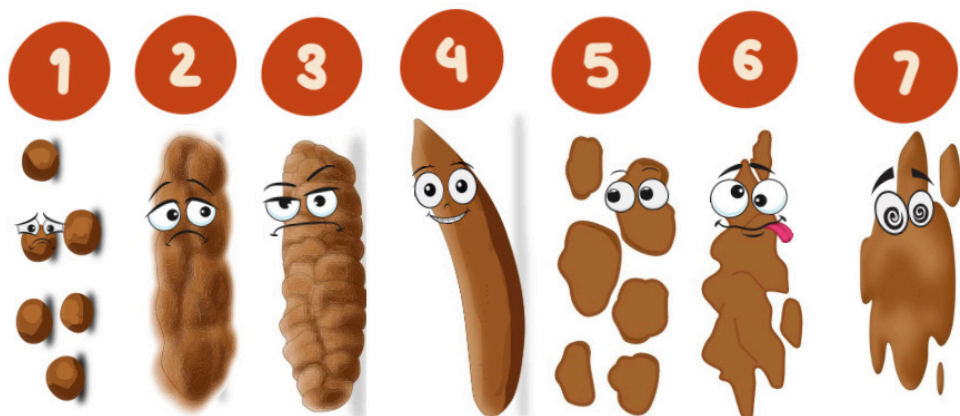
- There will be lots of poo so do have a chat with your child about this. It will take a couple of days to take effect so plan when you can take time off to do this as your child will need to stay at home. You might plan to do it over the midterm break or a long weekend and take a few days off after the weekend. You can start the regime and send to school etc for the first day or two but after that you will need to be home.
- Assign a toilet for your child to use if you have more than one loo. If not warn the rest of the family that the child doing the disimpaction may need to use it urgently so to be mindful of that. Not all children will experience urgency and will make it to the loo in plenty of time but some won't. If appropriate some younger children may need to use a pull up for this period of time- discuss with the child that if they previously were out of nappies that this is just temporary and they will be back in underwear again soon.
- Bum skin may become irritated and sore to use soft cloth or muslin cloth to clean the skin, water can sometimes be harsh on delicate skin so an olive oil can be used to clean. Use a barrier cream at all times and allow some air to the skin if possible for short periods of time.

- Some children will experience tummy cramps - give some paracetamol according to their weight. Use a hot pack, do a tummy massage too can help. Encourage exercise throughout the day too to help keep those bowels moving
- Keep a diary of how much is drunk each day of the macrogol and what poos are being passed. Compare the poo to the Bristol stool chart. This can also be a great way to keep your child motivated to stick with the regime if they can see the effect the macrogol is having on their poo.
- It is very important that your child drinks their usual fluid intake for the day as well as the dose of macrogol. The macrogol will pass through the body virtually unabsorbed so it is not included in their fluid intake for the day. It is recommended that a child have 6-8 glasses of water passed drinks a day.
- Use puppy training pads or mattress protector sheets on your furniture/car seat/buggy in case of poo leaks.
- Dress your child in loose clothing and the less clothes the better so it's easy for them to get to the loo and pull down underwear.
- Plan some activities that you can do when at home so that the focus isn't all on the poo! Do some arts and crafts, movie days, treasure hunt etc.

Maintenance dose and beyond...

- Once the brown/rusty water with specs of poo has appeared for 24 hours then it is time to reduce to half the dose - so if it took 8 sachets a day then reduce to 4 etc. Leave it at this then for 5-7 days to allow the bowel to settle. Expect poo to stay watery and then become sloppy but the frequency will reduce. Then further reduce by a sachet every 4-7 days until a type 4 poo is being passed. This can take time and don't rush it.
- Optimise their daytime bowel pattern by making sure they are drinking enough eating a well balanced diet, doing an hour of exercise, responding to the urge to poo or doing a timed toileting sit. When sitting on the loo make sure they are sitting correctly and for long enough.
- It is common that a child may need to do another disimpaction. If constipation has been a long term issue this is likely.
- Be mindful of when constipation can reoccur (teething, sick with any illness, change in routine, going on holidays, if refusing to take the macrogol) and adjust dose of daily macrogol accordingly. You may need to stop giving a macrogol if your child is unwell and unable to tolerate it but do start it back again once they are able.
- If your child is refusing to take a certain macrogol do discuss with your GP or pharmacist about an alternative.

POO AND THE LOO VERSION OF THE BRISTOL STOOL CHART



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CORRECT POSITION ON THE LOO

